The Lamp of the Precious View

Toh 4451 · Derge Tengyur
ལྟ་བ་རིན་ཆེ་སགྲོན་མ

The Lamp of the Precious View, in Tibetan Lta ba rin po che'i sgron ma, is a short verse treatise on the view of the Great Perfection and Mahāyoga tradition, attributed in its colophon to the master Palyang, known in Sanskrit as Śrīghoṣa, though many scholars identify him with the early Tibetan figure Ba Palyang. It teaches that the mind of awakening is primordially unborn, pure and equal to the minds of all buddhas, and that saṃsāra and liberation are like a dream: real only in appearance, yet with cause and result unfailing within it. Through the extended simile of a dreamer poisoned and healed, it explains how afflictions, suffering, the path and awakening all unfold, and it urges the practitioner to unite wisdom and skillful means, the two accumulations and the three bodies, without grasping at signs. It is Toh 4451 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the collection of tantric treatises.

Here is The Lamp of the Precious View.

The mind of awakening, primordially unborn and utterly pure,
Is from the very beginning equal to the minds of the ocean of Victors.
Through the illusory distinction between awareness and delusion,
Existence and liberation appear as cause and result.

Because there are no entities, there is no conceiving of entities either.
Bearers of qualities are not apprehended, and the nature of reality does not exist.
Apart from teaching about conditions in order to turn back clinging,
In the state of the Dharma there are no words; it is inexpressible.

Toward a mirage, which does not exist even as it appears,
The knowing do not form the thought that it is nonexistent.
The wise, who realize that phenomena are by nature unborn,
Do not superimpose an unborn emptiness upon them.

One endowed with self-aware intelligence, nondual and free of elaboration,
Unborn just as it is and primordially at peace,
Does not abide even in a mere inexpressible state;
How then could such a one grasp at entities and conventions?

Although the selfless dharmakāya, the essence of awakening,
Is not something sought and obtained from elsewhere,
Just as on waking from a dream one is free of its forms,
The Victor said that when obscurations are abandoned, awakening is attained.

Just as a person in a dream drinks poison,
So should one understand afflictions and karma, the causes of existence.
The unbearable suffering of the dream's poison sickness
Is the suffering of saṃsāra: birth, aging, sickness and death.

Like the medicine that cures the dream sickness,
The noble path and the many liberations should be understood.
The moments of gradually recovering from suffering
Are the way that wisdom and concentration arise in special form.
Finding the happiness of recovery, once the dream sickness is cleared,
Is the example for attaining awakening, the nature of mind.

Just as, within the dream itself, cause and result do not deceive,
So it is certain for those asleep in ignorance.
One who has woken from the sleep of stupor and is endowed with wisdom,
Knowing saṃsāra to be under the sway of what is merely dreamlike,
Strives for the aim of the noble path and clearly knows the result,
Yet, the nature being unchanging, has no conceit of attainment.

If the meaning of equality is not made equal with one's mind,
Mere verbal equality will not turn back the torrent of thought.
Though hell and the rest of saṃsāra never stir from equality,
One wanders through existence in unending suffering.
Having understood that the primordially pure has nothing to attain,
One strives intently in the yoga of wisdom and skillful means,
And by gathering all the qualities of great body and speech,
How could one be tainted with the fault of signs?

Having purified the mind of wrong ideas through supreme wisdom,
The great accumulation of wisdom is the Victor's dharmakāya.
Having gained mastery of concentration with the major and minor marks,
The great accumulation of merit is the Victor's form body.
One does not regard them as accomplished by way of karmic ripening,
Nor does one obtain wisdom from somewhere else.
By applying the three bodies just as they are, the supreme result
Is also the cause, in that it is accomplished through effort.

One's own mind is the yoga, the wisdom and the concentration.
As a sentient being, one enters the domain of the Sugatas.
One does not make aspirations for a pure realm,
But meditates on the five degenerations themselves as the abode of bliss.
Though wisdom is without abiding, free of the dust of attachment,
Compassion never wearies of the realm of sentient beings.
The marks of illusion, unceasing, are directly perceived,
And are realized as the ultimate expanse, signless and of a single taste.

The Lamp of the Precious View, composed by the master Śrīghoṣa, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Bearers of qualities" renders chos can (dharmin). In "gained mastery of concentration" and "under the sway of," dbang has its ordinary sense of power or mastery, not empowerment. "The abode of bliss" (bde ldan gnas) may allude to Sukhāvatī, which is contrasted with the pure realm in the previous line. The author dpal dbyangs is given as Śrīghoṣa, the usual Sanskrit form, but many scholars identify him with the Tibetan Ba Palyang.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.